



Online classes at Nexus

mote peer-to-peer interactions and side conversations during these extended informal hours

- Using breakout rooms in Zoom to create smaller groups for exercises and discussions between startups
 - Switch back and forth between presentations and videos so that everyone can see each other rather than continually having to look at a PowerPoint presentation
- We spoke to Saiprasad Poyarekar,

Founder and CEO, Pacify Medical, a startup that was part of exclusively online Cohort 10. He told Digit about his experience, “Nexus helped us understand the nuts and bolts of how to commercialise our technology and gave us the support and knowledge required to be successful”. Aakar Innovations is another startup that experienced the virtual sessions conducted by Nexus for Cohort 10. Founder Jaydeep Mandal shared his

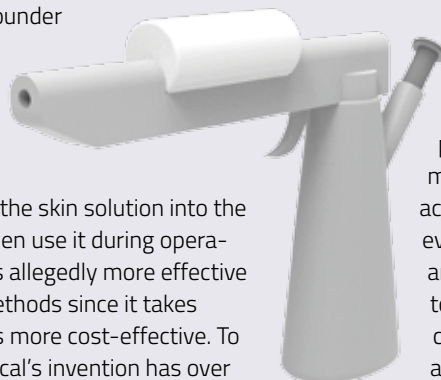
experience, “Nexus helped us understand how to convey information to consumers in layman’s terms which is extremely important when marketing a product. It is the key to having a successful campaign”.

ADOPTING UNIQUE APPROACHES

Unlike some other incubators, Nexus Incubator has taken up the approach of not charging any equity or fees from its participating startups and all their programs are completely free of charge – and this is something that Digit loves, and is also aiming to do through our #IndiaProject initiative. The entrepreneurs only had to bear the expenses of travel and stay when the program was still physically conducted in New Delhi. Azulay said, “The reason we can do this is the generous support of the US Embassy”. Nexus is funded wholly by the US Department of State and the mission is to discover and support Indian startups to enable them to be successful in both the Indian and

PACIFY MEDICAL (COHORT 10)

To assist plastic surgeons that have difficulty in finding healthy skin for skin transfer surgeries and/or treating serious burn wounds, Pacify Medical Technologies has developed a patented skin spray gun that enables large wound coverage by spraying stamp-sized skin. Saiprasad Poyarekar, Founder and CEO, Pacify Medical stated, “The skin spray gun works with a single click of a button. Surgeons graft a stamp-sized skin graft, mince it and then load the skin solution into the device (the spray gun) and then use it during operations”. Poyarekar’s solution is allegedly more effective than current skin grafting methods since it takes much less time to heal and is more cost-effective. To explain the edge Pacify Medical’s invention has over traditional grafting methods, Poyarekar said, “To understand how, we must first understand skin expansion ratio, which is how much skin can be stretched to cover a wound in skin transplantation surgeries. The higher the skin expansion, the better it is, since surgeons then need much less skin to cover a large wound. Current skin grafting devices provide an expansion of 1:4 to 1:6 times.



In comparison, the skin spray gun provides a much higher skin expansion ratio and also automates the process (instead of manual grafting)”. The healing process is much faster, as per Poyarekar, so patients can be discharged mere days after their surgery, avoiding potentially weeks of hospitalisation, which translates to exorbitant hospitalisation fees.

Recently, the startup was awarded a grant of 9,000 USD under the TIDE 2.0 program of the MeitY Startup Hub. Poyarekar mentioned that the grant is helping them accelerate the development process and it will even allow them to hire more engineers that are crucial for R&D, which will ultimately lead to a pathway to commercialisation. As of now, clinical validation and trials are underway and the startup tells us that the results will be disclosed post trials. The startup is also

supported by a few other reputed organisations such as the Biomedical Engineering and Technology Innovation Centre (BETiC Lab), the Society for Innovation and Entrepreneurship (SINE IIT – Bombay), Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (BIRAC), and the Ministry of Defense.